



A Google search for Lionel Messi shows his Twitter handle and Instagram account amongst the first few results

results. Take the following image of a google search for Lionel Messi. Within the first page of the search results, the social media accounts that he owns and operates feature prominently. A lot of traffic is automatically diverted towards social media accounts in this manner. This holds true for every person and corporation. Diversification through social media accounts on multiple platforms therefore, provides a bigger range of data for search engines to index and is likely to increase traffic.

Using Open Graph to drive traffic

An extremely useful tool that marketing media experts have at their disposal is Open Graph. The Open Graph tool allows developers to place meta tags in the <head> part of the code of the website with the intention of exercising control over how information is shared between Facebook as an application and any third party website that is shared on it. There is very little direct optimisation that occurs by using Open Graph but the benefits of learning Open Graph are still worth it as it will lead to better performance of your social media pages which in turn affects search results indirectly. There are quite a few characteristics that you can influence using metatags. Some of the basic characteristics are

- *og:title – It is the title of the content you wish to share. The title by default is assumed to be the name of the link. It is advisable to keep this to a reasonable length while keeping the key content of the link visible

- *og:url – This is the URL for the shared page, but it's possible to provide multiple links that the share can lead to depending on different parameters